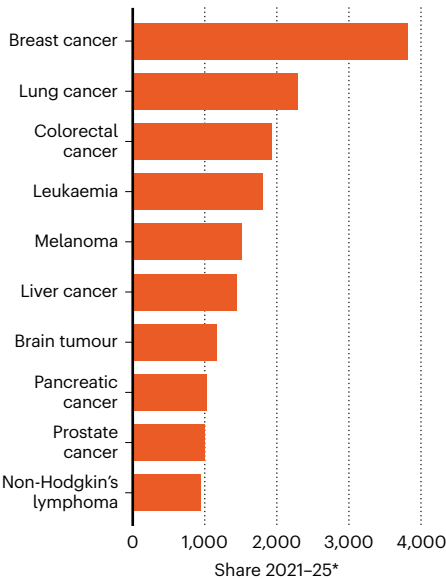


Cancer specialists

A breakdown of cancer-related publications in the Nature Index reveals the cancer types with the highest output, and the leaders of the field. **Data analysis by Aayush Kagathra. Infographic by Bec Crew and Tanner Maxwell.**

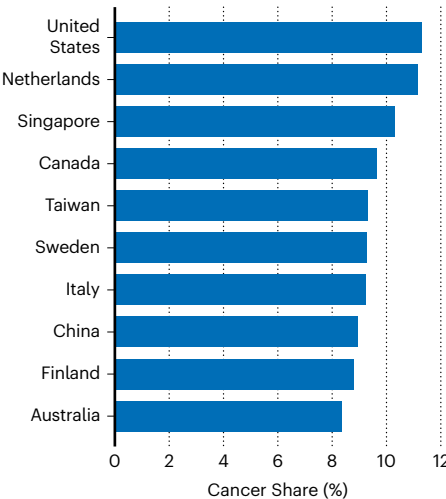
LEADING CANCER TYPES

A ranking of the top 10 cancer types by output reveals a strong lead for breast cancer, at more than 1,500 Share points ahead of lung cancer, in second.



STRONG FOCUS

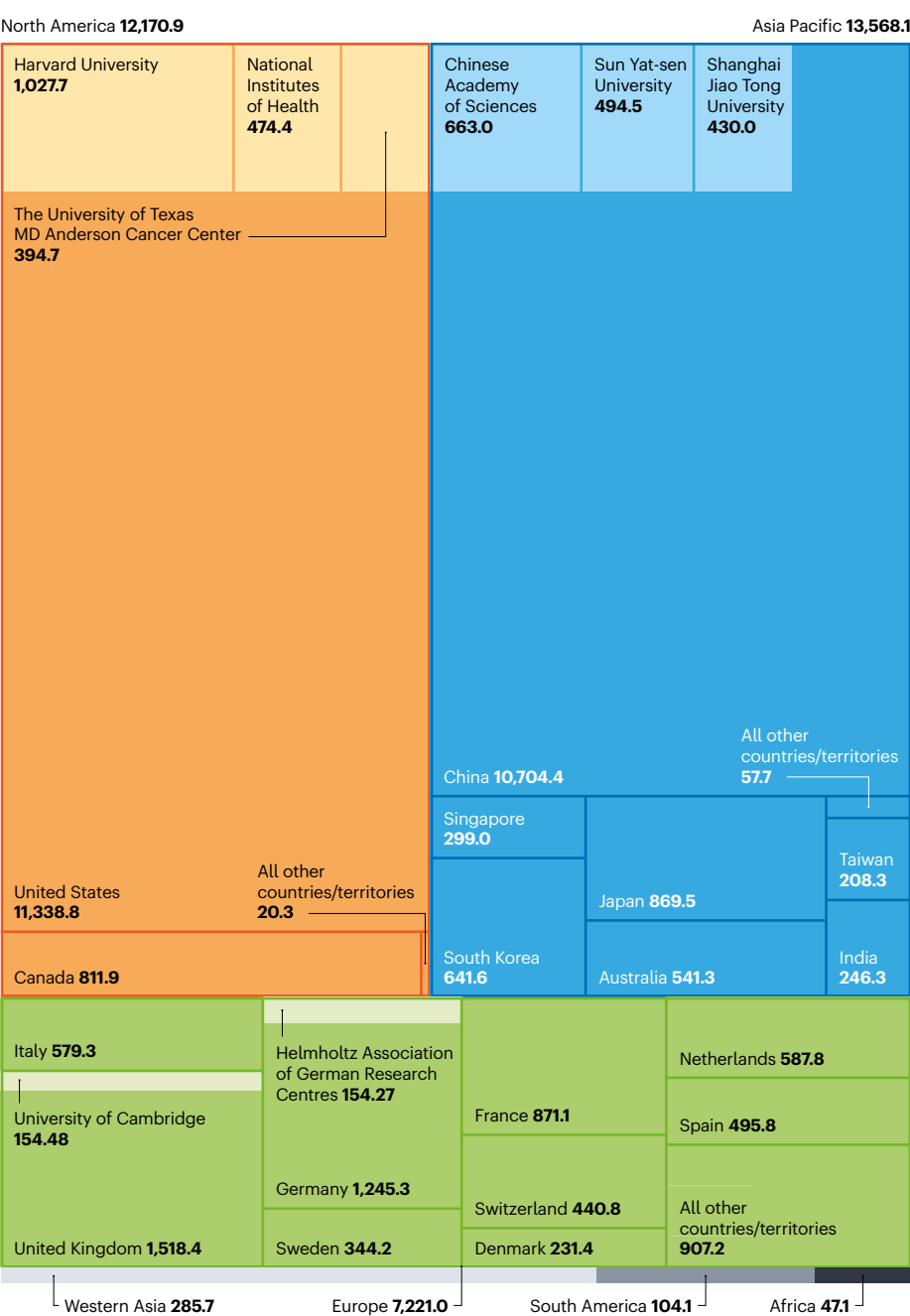
Among the leading 25 locations for cancer Share from 2021 to 2025*, these locations had the highest cancer output as a proportion of their overall Share in the Nature Index (cancer Share %). Cancer is a significant area of research for these places, accounting for around 10% of their total output in the natural- and health-sciences journals tracked by the index.



*Data for 2021 to 2025 cover January 2021 to August 2025.

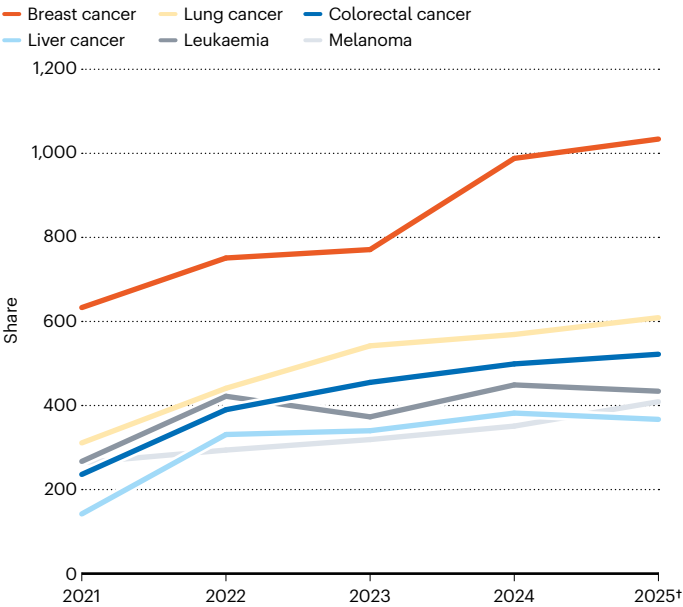
REGIONAL SPREAD

A breakdown of country/territory Share in cancer-related articles in the Nature Index for the period 2021 to 2025* shows how close the United States and China are in output. Both countries contribute about 30% of global cancer Share. The United Kingdom, with the third highest Share, contributes 4.55%.



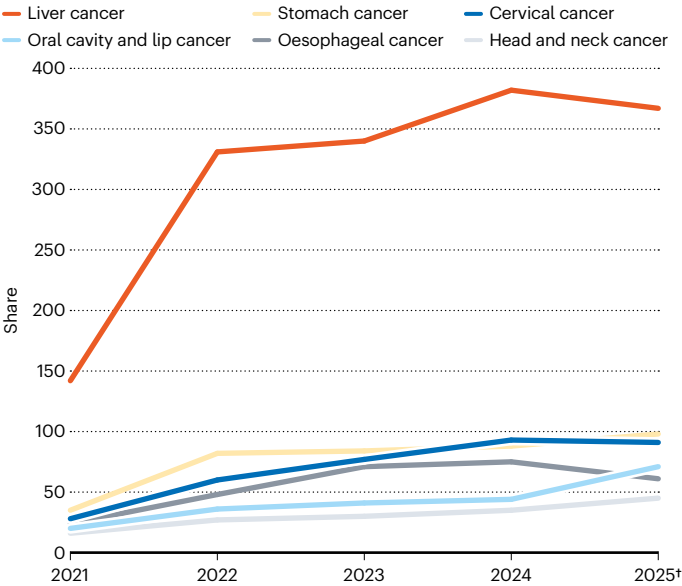
ARTICLE GROWTH

These are the six fastest rising cancer subtypes by absolute increase in Share in the Nature Index between 2021 and 2025*. Breast cancer, lung cancer and colorectal cancer also had the highest Share for the period.



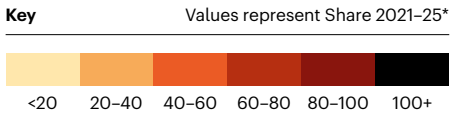
RISING FAST

Among the top 20 cancer subtypes for research output in 2025*, these six had the highest percentage increases in Share between 2021 and 2025*. Although most of these cancers started from a low output base, liver cancer had a relatively high Share in 2021 and it jumped by more than 150% over the period.



MAPPING OUTPUT

The leading institutions in the Nature Index by cancer Share for 2021 to 2025* are shown against their Share in the top cancer types. Harvard University in Cambridge, Massachusetts, stands out for having very high Share in breast and lung cancer. The Chinese Academy of Sciences in Beijing also has a clear focus on breast-cancer research. The University of Toronto in Canada is one of the only institutions outside China and the United States in the top 50 for cancer research (see tables on page S20).



Institution	Country/territory	Breast cancer	Lung cancer	Colorectal cancer	Leukaemia	Melanoma	Liver cancer	Brain tumour	Pancreatic cancer	Prostate cancer
Harvard University	United States	110.1	97.4	51.3	79.4	58.4	24.4	63.0	31.0	44.4
Chinese Academy of Sciences	China	79.3	29.8	35.6	8.8	31.6	20.6	14.9	16.0	10.1
Sun Yat-sen University	China	52.9	33.6	49.2	8.9	25.1	55.2	15.6	14.4	6.1
National Institutes of Health	United States	49.4	49.6	28.0	35.3	25.3	23.4	6.1	12.2	19.3
Shanghai Jiao Tong University	China	37.5	29.4	40.0	22.2	26.4	22.7	11.3	19.6	15.6
Fudan University	China	65.6	26.5	29.7	4.0	17.0	43.6	15.3	23.4	9.1
The University of Texas MD Anderson Cancer Center	United States	47.5	57.7	25.6	38.7	25.4	8.1	15.7	35.7	16.3
Zhejiang University	China	45.5	16.9	27.9	14.9	26.4	42.9	5.9	17.1	3.4
Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center	United States	40.8	50.2	25.1	34.5	21.9	4.1	8.4	22.2	22.8
Stanford University	United States	30.9	31.0	9.4	21.0	8.3	9.4	15.4	7.3	6.6
Nanjing University	China	33.7	10.1	13.1	0.3	13.7	16.9	15.4	7.1	1.3
Sichuan University	China	44.6	29.6	15.6	2.3	16.5	18.8	7.3	9.5	9.0
Peking University	China	27.8	19.8	24.5	4.9	14.0	12.4	2.8	6.6	5.6
University of Toronto	Canada	30.4	21.0	11.1	23.6	7.8	5.8	27.8	11.7	16.1

*Data for 2021 to 2025 cover January 2021 to August 2025. *Data for 2025 represent the period September 2024 to August 2025